

Synthetic-media Discourse Analysis

Facilitator field guide

Notice. Discuss. Check. Reflect.

VERSION 1.5 / 6 OCT 2026



A visual companion for community groups, workshop hosts and trainers. Use the four activities to explore how AI-generated and traditional media are made, compare different kinds of evidence and decide a practical next step.

The app brings Community Workshop, Developer and Facilitator guide together. Prepared examples open saved findings. These screenshots illustrate the workshop journey; the entered responses are examples for this guide.

An academic research project of **Synthetic Realities**, led by **Dr Sam Martin**, Smart Data Research UK (UKRI) Fellow (Grant number UKRI4010), Manchester Metropolitan University (MMU). [ORCID: 0000-0002-4466-8374](https://orcid.org/0000-0002-4466-8374).

Open the interactive demo: sdavision.io

WORKSHOP ACTIVITY 1

1

Notice

Make room for first impressions.

What catches your eye?



Community table scene (practice example)

Look at the hands, faces, text, shadows and background. What stands out to you?

How do you think it was made?

Choose all that fit, or choose "Not sure yet" on its own.

- ☐ Photo
- ☐ Drawn or painted by a person
- ☐ Made with AI
- ☐ Mix of human and AI
- ☒ Not sure yet

What makes you think that? (optional)

The hands and tablet caught my eye. I would like to compare what others noticed.

Let's discuss →

Your first impression: Not sure yet

Workshop activity - prepared example and sample responses.

Questions for the group

- 1 Did different details catch people's attention?
- 2 Would anyone like more time to look or listen?
- 3 Which first impressions would you like to explore together?

Invite a quiet moment to look or listen. People can select more than one impression, add a note, or choose "Not sure yet".

Start with the community table scene, labelled as a practice example. Its creation details appear at Check, after people have shared first impressions. The menu also offers other prepared media.

WORKSHOP ACTIVITY 2

2

Discuss

Explore the reasons behind a view.

What helped you form that view?



Community table scene (practice example)

Look at the hands, faces, text, shadows and background. What stands out to you?

What would help you decide?

Your first impression: **Not sure yet**

Your Notice note

The hands and tablet caught my eye. I would like to compare what others noticed.

What shaped your view? Choose any.

- ☒ Small visual details
- ☐ Light, shadows or textures
- ☐ Words, labels or claims
- ☐ Something I cannot place

What did you notice or talk about? (optional)

We noticed different details and want to compare them with the recorded checks.

[< Previous step](#)

Let's check together →

You picked 1 cue. What other explanation might fit?

Workshop activity - prepared example and sample responses.

Questions for the group

- 1 Did someone notice something different?
- 2 Can the same detail have more than one explanation?
- 3 What question would help the group move forward?

Invite people to point to a detail and explain why it matters. Compare explanations before opening the findings.

The Notice note appears here to support discussion. Use "Let's check together" when the group is ready to open the saved findings. People can revisit earlier responses throughout the activity.

WORKSHOP ACTIVITY 3

3

Check

Connect each finding to its evidence.

Recorded analysis Recorded findings opened. The analysis date is retained in the report.

What the checks suggest

① The checks lean towards AI-made or altered content

3 visual models (Claude, OpenAI and Google Gemini) agree this is likely synthetic. Compare these readings with the source and context.
Visual assessment covers the submitted image.
Local file clues provide supporting observations, listed separately from the model agreement.

Claude Visual model Complete	Synthetic likely 82 / 100 Recorded confidence: medium Find out why
OpenAI Visual model Complete	Synthetic likely 78 / 100 Recorded confidence: medium Find out why
Google Gemini Visual model Complete	Synthetic likely 72 / 100 Recorded confidence: medium Find out why
C2PA Content Credentials Content Credentials Complete	Inconclusive Origin check Find out why
Local forensic cues Supporting file clues Complete	Partially synthetic 41 / 100 Recorded confidence: low Supporting observations, considered alongside the model assessments. Find out why

Synthetic ratings: 0-100; higher values lean more synthetic. Ratings are not calibrated probabilities.

[About this file](#)

Workshop activity - prepared example and sample responses.

Questions for the group

- 1 What did each check cover?
- 2 Which findings come from a file record, a model or a person's observation?
- 3 Where could the group look for the missing evidence?

Use "Let's check together" in Discuss to open the saved findings. Compare their coverage with the group's first impressions. Direct entry to Check offers "Open recorded findings".

Expand "Find out why" beneath each reading. "About this file" below the table explains any creation label. For the podcast, distinguish transcript findings from the Sound tab's short-excerpt description. Ratings are not calibrated probabilities.

WORKSHOP ACTIVITY 4

4

Reflect

Turn the discussion into a useful next step.

How do you see it now?

Your first impression
Not sure yet

SDA's assessment
The checks lean towards AI-made or altered content

Your Notice note
The hands and tablet caught my eye. I would like to compare what others noticed.

Your Discuss note
We noticed different details and want to compare them with the recorded checks.

Your view now
Choose all that fit, or choose "Not sure yet" on its own.

☐ Photo

☐ Drawn or painted by a person

☒ Made with AI

☐ Mix of human and AI

☐ Not sure yet

What would you do next? Choose any.

☐ Find the original source

[Open Google Lens](#)

[Download original file](#)

Use the camera icon to choose an image to share with Google. Google's account settings and terms apply separately from SDA.

☐ Compare with other evidence

☐ Ask someone with relevant expertise

☒ Pause before sharing

What will you take away? (optional)

I will compare the evidence and pause before sharing a claim.

[← Previous step](#)

[Download session notes](#)

[+ New session](#)

Your view has moved from "Not sure yet" to "Made with AI". What influenced that change?

Questions for the group

- 1 What changed people's views, and what stayed uncertain?
- 2 Which next step feels practical in everyday life?
- 3 How would you explain the findings to someone else?

Guide the reflection

Revisit the Notice and Discuss notes. Invite a later view, a practical next action and an optional takeaway. A changed view and a remaining uncertainty can both contribute to the discussion.

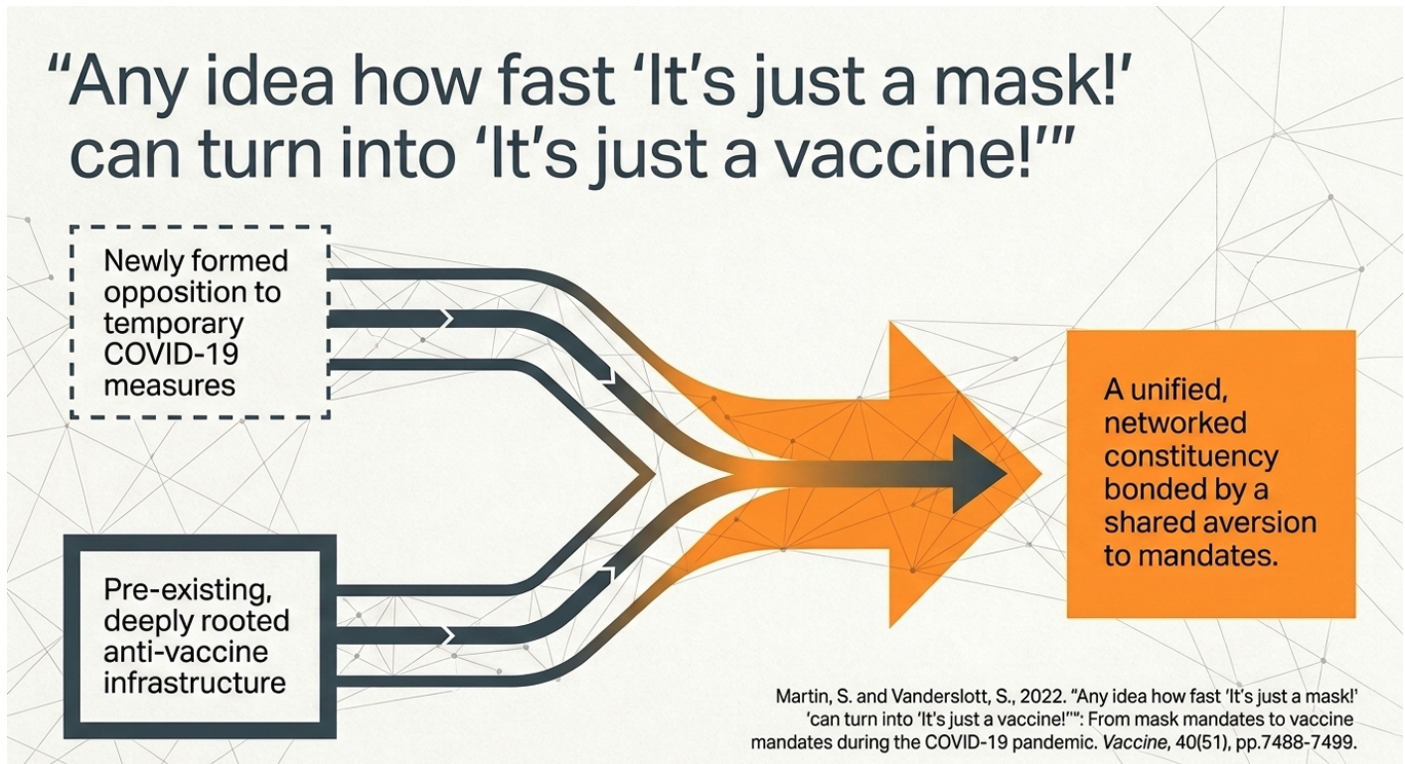
Take the notes away

Choose PDF, PowerPoint or CSV, then "Download session notes". Include workshop responses when wanted. Second Opinion notes precede the Session record. "New session" offers saving and an acknowledgement before clearing the page.

Example responses are shown. The saved model assessment retains its original scores and date.

Follow the source

How was it made? What does it draw on? How faithfully does it represent that source?



Notice: Listen to a short section. What shapes your first impression of how this podcast was made?

Discuss: Take a closer look at the cover image. Which names, dates or references could help you trace its source?

Check: Search for a distinctive phrase from the title or the authors' names. Find the publication, then compare one podcast statement with the paper.

Reflect: What have you learned about the research and the podcast's production? How would you describe both when sharing it?

[Search Google for the publication](#) | [Read the research paper](#)

Source reveal - after the group explores

Dr Sam Martin created this podcast using Google NotebookLM, drawing on research she co-authored with Samantha Vanderslott in *Vaccine*. The recorded model findings concern the transcript's wording and presentation. Compare individual statements to assess how the podcast summarises, simplifies or extends the research.

Martin, S. and Vanderslott, S. (2022). From mask mandates to vaccine mandates during the COVID-19 pandemic. *Vaccine*, 40(51), pp. 7488-7499. DOI: 10.1016/j.vaccine.2021.10.031. Full title and citation appear on the cover above.

Make it your session

Before the group arrives

Open the public demo on the intended device and screen. Choose from the prepared examples, test sound or the presentation's slide controls, and try a session download. Keep a saved copy of this guide available.

Keep participation flexible

Offer time to look or listen, think quietly, talk in pairs or respond aloud. People can pass and revisit a response. Agree what, if anything, the facilitator will record outside the app.

Choose the pace together

A short session can follow one example through all four activities. A longer workshop can compare AI-generated and traditional media. The same questions can support discussion before and after opening the saved findings.

Working with external checks

Reflect offers Google Lens and an original-file download for image examples. The Evidence box provides Second Opinion routes. Participants choose what to attach under the external service's account settings and terms. Pasted replies and workshop notes stay separate from the saved assessment.

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Credits and scope

Screenshots: SDA Vision, workshop-review-2026-09-27.2; sample responses for this guide. Opening illustration: Dr Sam Martin, Smart Data Research UK (UKRI) Fellow (Grant number UKRI4010), Manchester Metropolitan University (MMU), 2026; AI-generated artwork. Saved opening-image model analysis: 26 September 2026. Podcast text findings cover about 46% of the transcript; a separate Google Gemini description covers the first 20 seconds of sound. AI-origin detection from the sound itself is outside this workflow.

SDA: Synthetic-media Discourse Analysis. Guide version 1.5. Includes a podcast source-tracing activity. The workshop screenshots illustrate the four steps; the live interface may vary. MIT licence; project and illustration attribution retained. Partner logos identify the affiliation and funding; their rights remain with their owners.

[Open the interactive demo](#)